

Welcome to Forensic Science

What we want to be able to do by end of the year:

1. Use a critical process of discovery when observing a new crime scene or piece of evidence.
2. Use a critical process to decide whether a claim is supported or disproven.
3. Engage in constructive conversations with peers in order to achieve a shared goal.
4. Model crime scenes and evidence with drawings, diagrams, and/or mathematics.



What is Forensic Science according to Mr. Porter?

Forensic science is the application of science to criminal investigation. It includes subjects such as fingerprinting, DNA analysis, toxicology, ballistics, and entomology. These are the tools we use to figure out what really happened. Forensic science has something for everyone: part scientist, part detective, part lawyer. The skills we will learn in this class can be applied across many jobs, from the crime lab to the courtroom. If you take the time and put in the effort to learn them, it will likely give you an upper hand in your career of choice.



Mr. Porter's Phone Policy

Due to changes in New Jersey law, there will be no phones allowed within the classroom during school. Each student is provided an assigned pocket number where they can place their phone during class. Otherwise, students can leave their phones in their bags. Phones should be off as to prevent distraction during instruction. If a student is caught using their phone in class, the consequences are:

1st offense: a warning and respectfully asking the offending student to place their phone in their assigned pocket.

2nd offense: Behavioral referral to a vice principal and the offending student will be required to place their phone into their assigned pocket during each class.

Each following offense: Behavioral referral to a vice principal.

Mr. Porter's expectations:

- Try your best everyday by being an active participant in your group. Try some of these things:
 - Be the person to **write** on the whiteboard.
 - Be the person to **organize** how the whiteboard should appear so that you can use its contents to help you improve assessment questions or study for major exams.
 - Be the person to **share** the idea that sparks conversation in your group.
- Have the courage to be incorrect.
- Allow others to be incorrect without fear.
- Consider others' emotions when speaking to them.
- Ask questions.
- Respect others' physical space and talking space.

GRADING POLICY

TYPE	PERCENT OF MARKING PERIOD GRADE	EXAMPLE
Assessment	65%	Assessment Questions, Case Files, Group Labs
Classwork	35%	Weekly Evidence Uploads, Graded Classwork Assignments

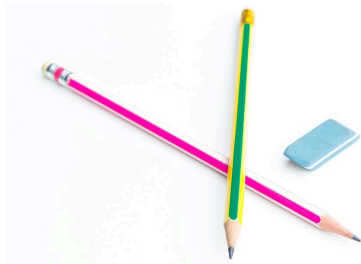
55% should be the lowest grade you receive in our class. If you give your best effort on any kind of assignment in our class, you will not receive any percentage grade lower than a 55% **even if you answer every question incorrectly.**

Rubric Level	% Grade Equivalent	Rubric Level	% Grade Equivalent
Refining	100%	Emerging	55%
Developing	85%	Little to no effort	0%
Approaching	65%		

Required Materials



Ruler



Pencil and Eraser



Whiteboard Markers



Calculator
(phone calculator can work)



Charged Chromebook

Recommended Materials



Folder



Mouse



Notebook

How to Contact Mr. Porter

Email: kellporter2@paps.net